

"Civility allows for zealous representation, reduces clients' costs, better advances clients' interests, reduces stress, increases professional satisfaction, and promotes effective conflict resolution. These guidelines foster the civility and professionalism that are hallmarks of the best traditions of the legal profession."

OCBA Civility Guidelines

"The American legal profession exists to help people resolve disputes cheaply, swiftly, fairly, and justly. Incivility between counsel is sand in the gears."

(*Karton v. Ari Design & Construction, Inc.* (2021) 61 Cal.App.5th 734, 747.)

TENTATIVE RULINGS
Judge Kimberly Knill, Dept. C31

- **The court encourages remote appearances to save time, reduce costs, and increase public safety.** Go to [Check-In Results - Orange County Superior Court](#) and click the blue box, "Click here to appear/check-in for Civil Small Claims/Limited/Unlimited/Complex remote proceedings." Navigate to Department C31 Judge Kimberly Knill.
- All hearings are open to the public.
- If you desire a transcript of the proceedings, you **must** provide your court reporter (unless you have a fee waiver and request a court reporter in advance).
- Call the other side. If **everyone** submits to the tentative ruling, call the clerk at **657-622-5231**. Otherwise, the court may rule differently at the hearing. (See *Lewis v. Fletcher Jones Motor Cars, Inc.* (2012) 205 Cal.App.4th 436, 442, fn. 1.)

No filming, broadcasting, photography, or electronic recording of the video session is permitted pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 1.150, and Orange County Superior Court rule 180.

HEARING DATE: Friday, 7/17/2026 10:00 AM

#	Case Name	Tentative
1	Thomas vs. Synched, LLC 30-2025-01472224-CU-OE-CJC	Motion to be Relieved as Counsel of Record The motion of attorney Scott Shibayama from Vision Law Corporation to be relieved as counsel of record for defendant Synched, LLC is GRANTED. Moving attorney has shown compliance with all the requirements of the California Rules of Court, Rule 3.1362. OSC re corporate counsel scheduled for 9/10/2026 at 1:30 PM. Defendant, Synched, LLC is a business entity that cannot be self-represented. Defendant, Synched, LLC is ORDERED to substitute new counsel into the case prior to the OSC. Failure to do so will result in the court striking its answer and entering default.

		Moving attorney is ORDERED to give notice to client, and file proof of service of the Court's order as entered. Withdrawal will be effective upon filing of proof of service of the order. Clerk to give notice.
2	Reyes vs. General Motors, LLC 30-2024- 01389233-CU- BC-CJC	Motion to Set Aside Dismissal Plaintiffs Sandra Reyes's and Juan Reyes's motion to set aside the dismissal entered on 9/22/2025 and reinstate case is DENIED. Plaintiffs have not demonstrated counsel's mistake, inadvertence, surprise, or neglect. (Code Civ. Proc., § 473, subd. (b).) Counsel was well aware of the trial date and any "overbooking" was not the result of a mistake but appears to have been scheduled intentionally by counsel. (Baggs Decl., ¶¶ 3, 8.) Plaintiffs have not demonstrated why counsel did not inform the Stanley Mosk Court they were already engaged in a trial in Orange County, nor addressed why both Plaintiffs failed to appear for trial as ordered. Clerk to give notice.
3	O'Connell vs. Channels 30-2024- 01428559-CU- FR-CJC	Motion to Continue Discovery The Motion to Continue Discovery by Plaintiffs Kevin O'Connell, Credit 1 Assist LLC, and Guru Finance Group, LLC is GRANTED. The Court has considered Defendants' opposition, which was untimely filed and served as a result of the parties' attempts to stay litigation while attempting dispute resolution. Plaintiffs have shown a short extension of the discovery cutoff to 8/10/2026 is appropriate in order to complete discovery which was not completed by prior counsel, and Defendants have not demonstrated prejudice because trial has been continued to 10/23/2026. (Code Civ. Proc., § 2024.050.) Clerk to give notice.
4	Morris vs. Newman	Motion to Appoint Receiver and Issuance of Preliminary Injunction